

MOTYA ALI

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OPERATIONS & BUSINESS SYSTEMS | PLANNING | IMPLEMENTATION | APPLIED AI

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Operations and business systems professional with 15+ years of experience translating complex data, requirements, and workflows into organized execution across retail planning, project administration, documentation, systems implementation, and applied AI.

SELECTED VALUE

- Built forecasting and inventory decision processes across high-SKU environments including furniture, apparel, cosmetics, footwear, eCommerce, and multi-category retail.
- Designed practical logic for demand forecasting, replenishment, inventory reconciliation, exception routing, source synthesis, and confidence-based decision support.
- Bridged operations, planning, vendors, warehouses, finance, technology, and executive stakeholders to make information more accurate, actionable, and scalable.
- Translate complex requirements into user guides, process maps, test evidence, training materials, and decision-ready status reporting.

CORE SKILLS

- **Operations & Project Administration:** Workflow coordination, deliverables, permissions, records, metadata, status reporting, issue resolution, stakeholder support
- **Planning & Forecasting:** Demand planning, receipt planning, replenishment logic, seasonal curves, promotions, margin, inventory targets, capacity alignment
- **Systems & Data:** Oracle ERP, SAP, RMS, MMS, MicroStrategy, SharePoint, Power Automate, advanced Excel, data mapping, ID normalization, dashboards
- **Documentation & Enablement:** SOPs, user guides, process maps, role-based training, governance, testing, implementation support
- **AI & Process Design:** AI-assisted workflows, retrieval concepts, exception queues, decision-support systems, audit trails, human-in-the-loop controls

SELECTED IMPACT

- Improved forecast accuracy by 40% and reduced stockouts by 30% during a Gymboree system migration through data normalization, forecast logic, safety-stock thresholds, dashboards, documentation, and training.
- Directed \$250M+ Kids & Baby inventory flow across 650+ Burlington stores and led an allocation team aligning inventory with capacity, demand patterns, and store performance.
- Managed \$500M+ fragrance category planning at Sephora and translated sales, inventory, vendor, promotion, margin, and demand signals into executive decisions.
- Forecasted and procured \$250M+ in Old Navy men's basic knits, balancing demand, promotions, receipt flow, inventory targets, margin, and lead times.
- Managed Levi's and Dockers eCommerce inventory flow and supported Amazon wholesale onboarding and online size expansion.
- Coordinated inventory flow and operational readiness for 45+ West Elm store openings in 12 months.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Computer Science Office Aide | City College of San Francisco | San Francisco, CA | 2026 - Present

- Support department operations, student-facing communications, and coordination for Information Technology and Computer Science activities.
- Developed the CCSF AI Interview Coach with the department's Employment and Training Specialist to support contextual interview practice.

Project Administrator | Chaves & Associates, SFPUC Water Capital Program | San Francisco, CA | 2025 - 2026

- Support SharePoint migration, document control, permissions, metadata, and workflow documentation for a multidisciplinary public-infrastructure program.
- Translate operational requirements into user guides, process maps, training materials, and decision-ready status updates.
- Develop structured documentation practices that improve visibility, accountability, and process consistency.

Co-Manager | Salida Home Market | Salida, CA | 2020 - 2024

- Managed store operations, purchasing records, vendor coordination, inventory tracking, order follow-up, stock organization, physical counts, FIFO, and reorder needs.

Senior Merchandise Planner | Appaman | New York, NY | 2023 - 2024

- Owned P&L and inventory planning for a full brand assortment, including procurement strategy, pricing, margin management, and operational planning.

Senior Merchandise Planner, Fragrances | Sephora | San Francisco, CA | 2021 - 2023

- Managed \$500M+ category P&L and forecasting and produced executive and vendor recaps translating performance into risks, opportunities, and actions.

Senior Inventory Planner, Shoes | Tailored Brands | Fremont, CA | 2019 - 2021

- Managed \$100M+ footwear inventory and consolidated vendor buys to improve cost leverage and reduce COGS by up to 15% while maintaining availability.

Merchandise Planner, Men's Tees | Old Navy | San Francisco, CA | 2018 - 2019

- Forecasted and procured \$250M+ in basic knit inventory, balancing demand, promotions, receipt flow, margin, and inventory targets.

Manager of Allocations, Kids & Baby | Burlington Stores | Burlington, NJ | 2017 - 2018

- Led 11 allocators managing \$250M+ inventory across 650+ stores.

Manager of Allocations, Crazy 8/Janie & Jack | Gymboree | San Francisco, CA | 2014 - 2017

- Served as SME for Oracle migration, bridged sales and inventory data across systems, and trained planners on tools replacing manual Excel processes.

Senior Allocator, Levi's/Dockers eCommerce | Levi Strauss & Co. | San Francisco, CA | 2011 - 2014

- Managed eCommerce inventory flow and supported Amazon wholesale onboarding and online size expansion.

Merchandise Location Planner | Ann Taylor Factory | San Francisco, CA | 2010 - 2011

- Planned location-level inventory to align sales, margin, assortment, and store demand.

Senior Distribution Planner / Special Projects | West Elm | Brooklyn, NY | 2004 - 2010

- Coordinated furniture inventory flow, delivery timing, store-opening readiness, and cross-functional logistics for major expansion activity.

SELECTED SYSTEMS PROJECTS

- **CCSF AI Interview Coach:** Developed a deployed public prototype using résumé and job-description context for conversational voice interview practice and grounded feedback.
- **AI Workflow Enablement:** Built five working demonstrations for meeting intelligence, document intake, status reporting, request triage, and governed knowledge assistance.
- **Inventory Truth Ledger:** Designed an ERP/WMS/TMS reconciliation architecture that normalizes PO, ASN, receipt, QC, RTV, and milestone signals into auditable states and exception queues.
- **SmartGrocer:** Developed an authenticated full-stack prototype with household data isolation, purchase records, replenishment forecasts, review controls, and automated tests.
- **AliOS / Unseen Lifeline:** Designed structured protocols separating source evidence, reasoning, human review, execution, and continuity for high-stakes administrative workflows.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- AS Degree in Computer Science, in progress | City College of San Francisco | Expected 2027
- Certificate of Achievement, Construction Administration | City College of San Francisco | 2025
- Responsible AI Foundations Professional Certificate | All Tech Is Human | 2026
- Selected IBM SkillsBuild credentials: Make Agentic AI Work for You; Team Essentials for Designing AI Solutions; Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner
- Google AI Essentials | Google